

Incident handler's journal

Instructions

As you continue through this course, you may use this template to record your findings after completing an activity or to take notes on what you've learned about a specific tool or concept. You can also use this journal as a way to log the key takeaways about the different cybersecurity tools or concepts you encounter in this course.

Date: 10/19/26	**Entry:** Entry 1
Description	A small healthcare clinic experienced a ransomware attack caused by a phishing email containing a malicious attachment the ransomware encrypted the clinics files and disrupted business operations
Tool(s) used	None in this scenario
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** unethical group of hackers • **What** the attackers gained access by sending targeted phishing emails • **When** tuesday morning at 9 am • **Where** small us help clinic • **Why** a phishing email was clicked and downloaded and deployed malware
Additional notes	The healthcare clinic could reduce the risk of future attacks by training employees to recognize phishing emails

Date: 10/30/26	**Entry:** 2
Description	In this activity i practiced analyzing network traffic using wireshark the goal was to understand how computers communicate over a network by examining captured packets
Tool(s) used	wireshark
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** caused the incident? • **What** happened? • **When** did the incident occur? • **Where** did the incident happen? • **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	I learned how packet analysis helps security analyst understand network communications and identify info that could be useful during a security investigation

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Date: 10/30/26	**Entry:** 3.
Description	Practiced identifying network interfaces and using tcpdump to capture and analyze network traffic the activity involved filtering http traffic on port 80 saving captured packets to a PCAP file and reviewing packet info using different tcpdump options

Tool(s) used	Linux,tcpdump,curl
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** I acted as a security analyst monitoring network traffic • **What** i used tcpdump to capture network packets save them in a .pcap file • **When** october 30, 2026 • **Where** in a google skills linux lab environment • **Why** to learn how security analyst capture and examine network traffic during investigations
Additional notes	This activity helped me understand how security analyst capture filter and examine network packers these skills can be useful when investigating unusual network activity or potential security incidents

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Date: 10/30/26.	**Entry: 4**
Description	I learned how to examine security alerts and network logs using suricata. I explored the eve.json file and used commands such as cat and jq to view and organize log data
Tool(s) used	**Suricata**
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** caused the incident? • **What** happened? • **When** did the incident occur?

	• **Where** did the incident happen? • **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	

Date: Record the date of the journal entry.	**Entry:** Record the journal entry number.
Description	Provide a brief description about the journal entry.
Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** caused the incident? • **What** happened? • **When** did the incident occur? • **Where** did the incident happen? • **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

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Description	Provide a brief description about the journal entry.
Tool(s) used	List any cybersecurity tools that were used.
The 5 W's	Capture the 5 W's of an incident. • **Who** caused the incident? • **What** happened? • **When** did the incident occur? • **Where** did the incident happen? • **Why** did the incident happen?
Additional notes	Include any additional thoughts, questions, or findings.

Need another journal entry template?

If you want to add more journal entries, please copy one of the tables above and paste it into the template to use for future entries.

Reflections/Notes: Record additional notes.